UX DESIGN TELECOMMUNICATIONS NAVIGATION IOS & ANDROID

Telefonica — A Guided Navigation Redesign

Redesigning Telefonica's digital self-service navigation from a cluttered, feature-heavy structure into a calm, task-oriented experience that guides customers through their journey with clarity and confidence.

ROLE
Senior UX Designer

PLATFORM
iOS, Android & Web

Standorte & Omnichannel
Telefónica

OVERVIEW

Why Telefonica's app was failing its customers

The Selfcare platform is designed as a unified digital solution across Telefónica's portfolio of brands, implemented through a white-label approach, enabling a single scalable design system adaptable for 12 Telefónica brands. This framework ensures consistent functionality while allowing brand-specific customization based on each brand's unique guidelines and visual identity. It provides both efficiency and flexibility, maintaining a unified experience across the Telefónica ecosystem.

User problem: Users managing multiple accounts struggled with navigation clarity

Product problem: Navigation was designed for single-account flows

52% Drop-off rate On core navigation flows	2.6★ App Store rating Public ratings	2× Task completion time Across top 5 user journeys	41% Support contacts Navigation-related queries

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

01	Discovery	Stakeholder interviews, support ticket analysis, VoC data, and analytics review to frame the problem
02	Generative	User interviews and contextual inquiry to understand workflows and pain points
03	Design	Translating research insights into user flows, wireframes, high fidelity prototypes - Iterating based on the feedback
04	Evaluative	Epic onwer walk through to validate UX is implemented correctly against the defined design intent
05	Post-launch	Ongoing feedback loops to surface emerging issues and validate long-term design decisions

RESEARCH ANALYSIS

What are the Reviews and Ratings received ?

Feedback highlights navigation within the app as an area for continued improvement. While many users find the main dashboard intuitive, others mention that some menus and service sections could be more streamlined —especially when switching between mobile, broadband, and add-on options.

App	Rating	Play Store	App Store
O2 App	3.95/5.0 ★★★★☆	3.8	4.1
Aldi Talk App	3.60/5.0 ★★★★☆	3.5	3.7
Blau App	3.75/5.0 ★★★★☆	3.6	3.9

POSITIVE

> Positive reviews often note that recent updates have improved overall app flow and responsiveness, making it easier to track data usage, manage plans, and access support. Still, users suggest enhancing in-app navigation cues and reducing the number of steps required to reach key settings for a smoother, more guided experience.

CONTEXT & PROBLEM

A navigation system nobody could navigate

The existing Telefonica app had no discernible guided journey. A new customer opening the app for the first time encountered the same dense menu as a 5-year subscriber. There was no progressive disclosure, no personalisation, and no indication of where a task would lead.

> *"I don't even know what half of these buttons do. I just want to see how much data I've used."*
>
> — USABILITY TESTING PARTICIPANT

The three primary pain points consistently surfaced across 14 usability sessions and 380 survey responses: navigation overload, absence of guided flows, and no feedback after completing an action.

PROBLEM 01

Navigation overload

Over 20 top-level items with no clear priority hierarchy. Customers couldn't distinguish primary tasks from secondary features, or find where account actions lived.

PROBLEM 02

No guided journey

Every customer — new or returning — received the same experience. There was no onboarding path, no 'start here' state, and no contextual help when users were lost.

PROBLEM 03

Zero feedback loops

After completing an action — submitting a request, changing a plan, paying a bill — there was no confirmation, no success state, and no next suggested step.

COMPETITIVE ANALYSIS

Where Telefonica stood against the market

I benchmarked Telefonica's existing navigation against four direct competitors across eight key UX dimensions. This informed which gaps were industry-wide versus Telefonica-specific, and helped prioritise the redesign scope.

CRITERIA	TELEFONICA (BEFORE)	VODAFONE	ORANGE	O2	EE
Clear navigation hierarchy	×	✓	✓	✓	✓
Guided onboarding flow	×	◑	✓	✓	◑
Task-oriented home screen	×	✓	◑	✓	✓
Visible data usage on home	×	✓	✓	×	✓
Transparent billing breakdown	◑	✓	✓	◑	✓
Confirmation / success states	×	✓	✓	✓	✓
Consistent component language	×	✓	◑	✓	✓
Accessible colour contrast	◑	✓	✓	✓	✓

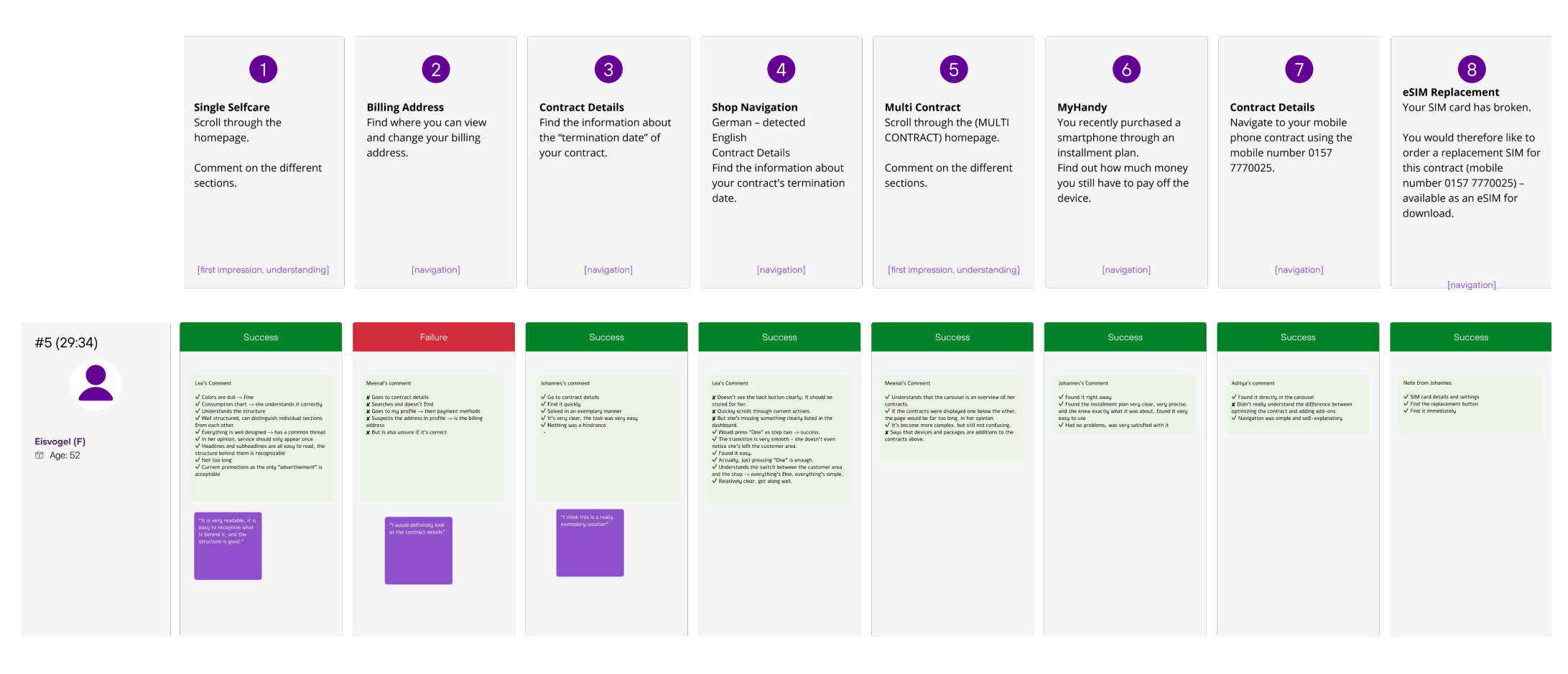
✓ Fully present · ◑ Partially present · × Not present

RESEARCH & DISCOVERY

What users actually said and did

I ran a three-week mixed-methods research sprint combining moderated usability sessions, an unmoderated survey (380 responses), and a full heuristic audit against Nielsen's 10 principles. The goal was not to validate assumptions — it was to understand what was genuinely broken.

4 New User - Less than one year	7 Established Customers 3-4 years with the brand	9 Long-Term Loyal 10+ years with the brand



1 **Single Selfcare** Scroll through the homepage. Comment on the different sections. [first impression, understanding]

2 **Billing Address** Find where you can view and change your billing address. [navigation]

3 **Contract Details** Find the information about the "termination date" of your contract. [navigation]

4 **Shop Navigation** German – detected English Contract Details Find the information about your contract's termination date. [navigation]

5 **Multi Contract** Scroll through the (MULTI CONTRACT) homepage. Comment on the different sections. [first impression, understanding]

6 **MyHandy** You recently purchased a smartphone through an installment plan. Find out how much money you still have to pay off the device. [navigation]

7 **Contract Details** Navigate to your mobile phone contract using the mobile number 0157 7770025. [navigation]

8 **eSIM Replacement** Your SIM card has broken. You would therefore like to order a replacement SIM for this contract (mobile number 0157 7770025) – available as an eSIM for download. [navigation]

USABILITY FINDINGS

FINDING 01

Navigation Issues

CRITICAL SEVERITY

- Users struggled to switch between accounts & users were unsure which account is active
- Users cannot access Invoice Settings

FINDING 02

Proximity Grouping Issues

CRITICAL SEVERITY

- Billing Address — Look for it under "Profile" and then "Address" or "Payment Methods"
- Users don't necessarily go straight to the shop page; they first check the dashboard for offers
- Users expect the billing address to be under "Profile" or "Contract Details"
- Suspects the address in profile → is the billing address
- The wording "Optimize Contract" is not entirely clear
- Thinks the address in profile is the billing address

DESIGN PROCESS

IA first. Then guided flows. Then polish.

The design process ran across three phases, with user testing at the close of each. No phase was signed off without validation. The hardest part wasn't designing the new experience — it was getting internal teams to agree on what should be in scope.

Phase 01 — Information Architecture
Weeks 1–3

- Open card sort with all participants
- Reduced 20+ home entries to 5 task-based primary categories
- Tree testing across 3 IA candidates — final structure chosen on first-attempt success rate
- Stakeholder workshop to align cross-functional teams on hierarchy decisions

Phase 02 — Guided Navigation Framework
Weeks 4–7

- Designed a contextual onboarding flow triggered on first session only
- Built a 'quick actions' persistent tray showing the top 3 tasks per persona segment
- Prototyped 65+ low-fidelity screens covering all primary and secondary flows
- 3 rounds of moderated usability testing — 18 participants across rounds

DESIGN PRINCIPLES

→ **Guide, don't overwhelm**
Surface the most likely next step for each user type. Hide everything else until it's needed.

○ **Every action has an end state**
Loading, success, error — all three get equal design attention. Silence after an action is never acceptable.

■ **One decision at a time**
Each screen presents a single decision. Complexity is revealed progressively, only when requested.

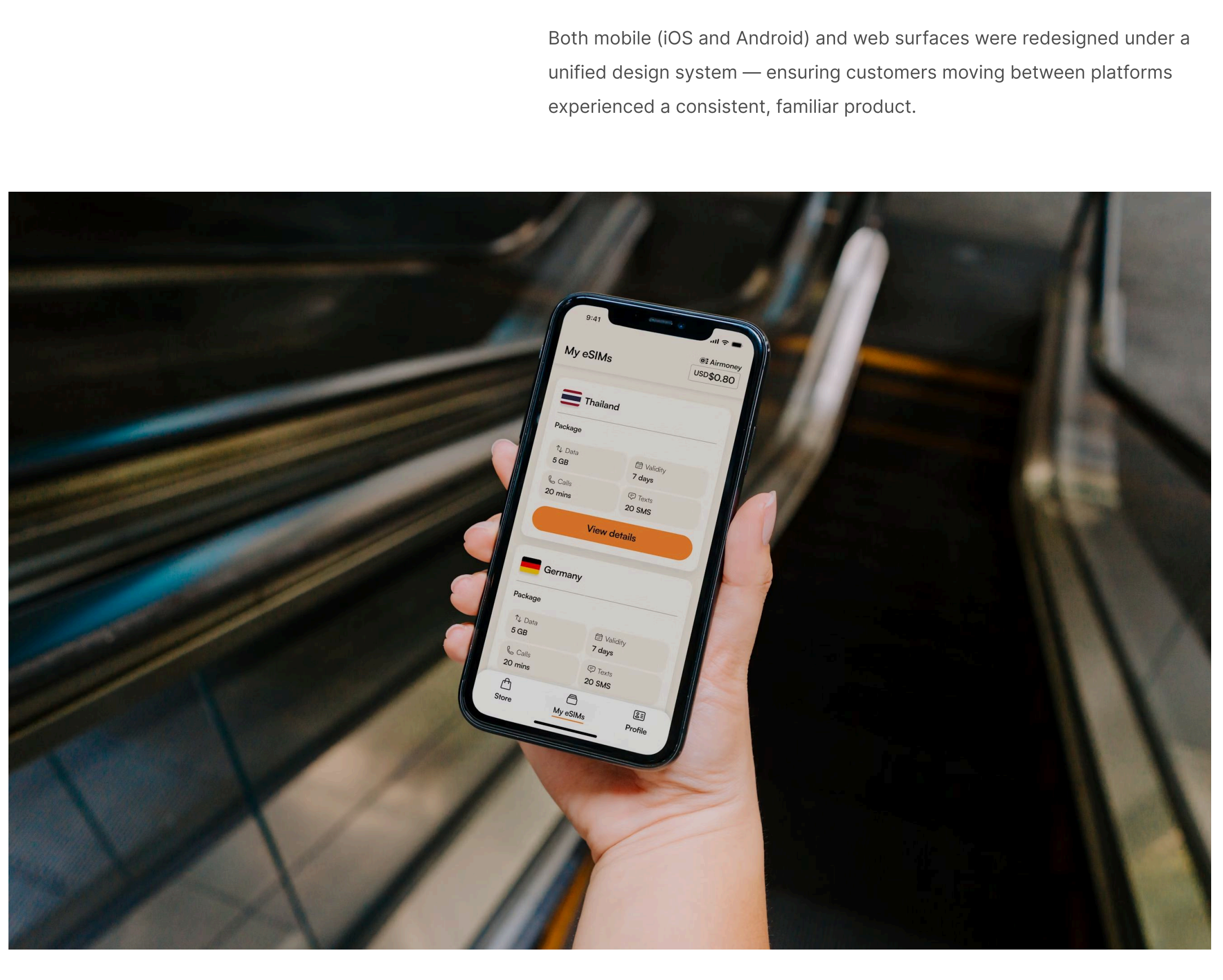
≡ **Structure from behaviour**
Navigation hierarchy is built on task frequency data, not product team preferences or feature count.

SOLUTION

Guided by task. Designed for trust.

The redesigned experience introduces a task-first home screen, a guided onboarding flow for new users, persistent quick-access to repeat actions, and clear feedback states across every interaction. Navigation was rebuilt from 20+ items to 5 clear destinations.

Both mobile (iOS and Android) and web surfaces were redesigned under a unified design system — ensuring customers moving between platforms experienced a consistent, familiar product.



Task-first home screen

The new home screen opens with the three things customers check most: data usage, next bill, and recent activity. The remaining 17 features are accessible but secondary — one deliberate tap away.

Guided onboarding flow

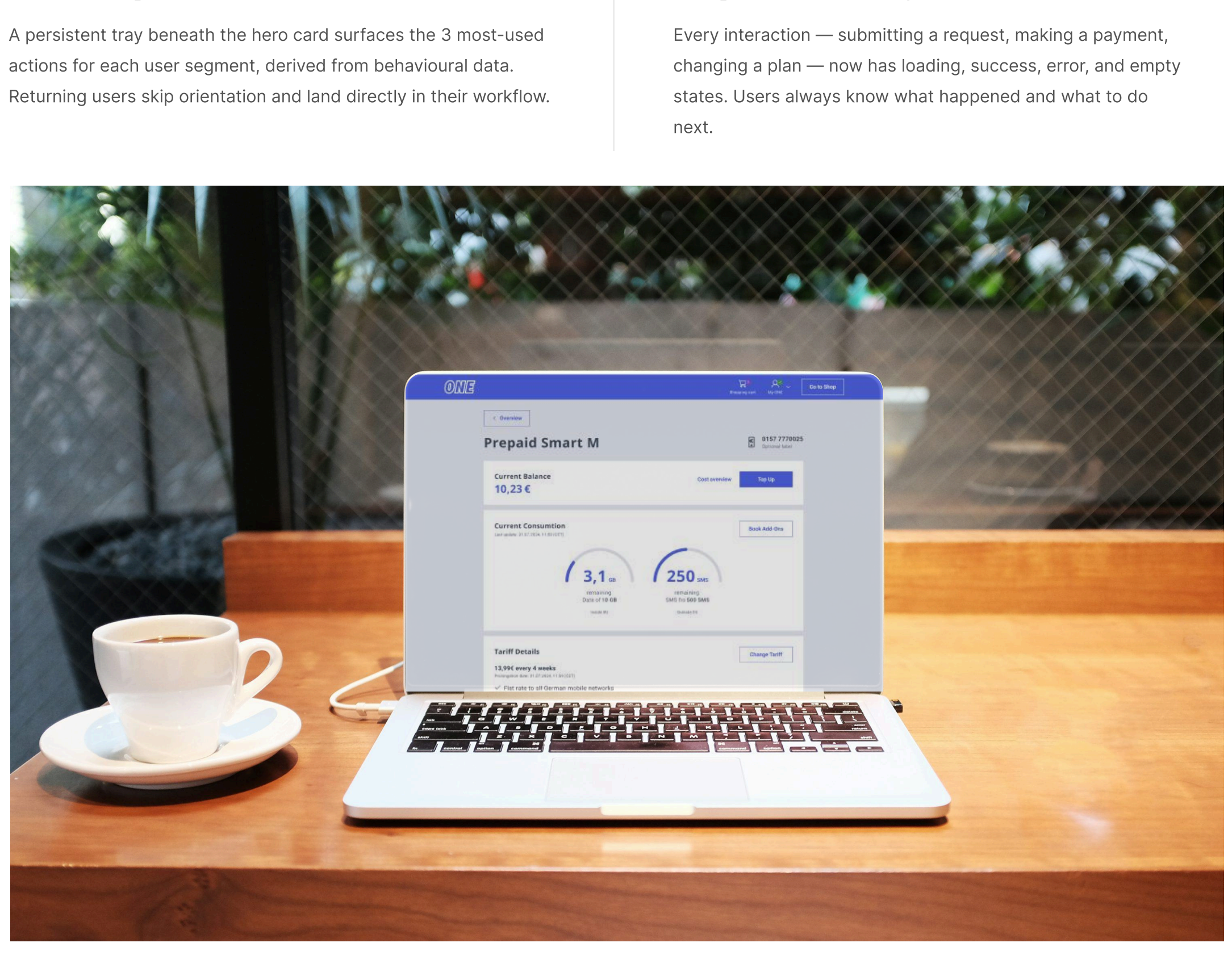
First-time users are walked through three orientation steps before reaching the home screen: what's included in their plan, how to track usage, and where to get help. Skippable at any point.

Contextual quick actions

A persistent tray beneath the hero card surfaces the 3 most-used actions for each user segment, derived from behavioural data. Returning users skip orientation and land directly in their workflow.

Complete state coverage

Every interaction — submitting a request, making a payment, changing a plan — now has loading, success, error, and empty states. Users always know what happened and what to do next.



BEFORE — NAVIGATION STRUCTURE

- Home
- My Account
- My Bills
- Data & Usage
- My Plan
- Extras & Add-ons
- Roaming
- Devices
- TV & Entertainment
- Insurance
- Technical Support
- Settings
- Offers & Rewards
- Refer a Friend
- My Documents
- + 6 more items

AFTER — REDESIGNED STRUCTURE

Home
Balance · Usage · Next bill · Quick actions

My Plan
Plan details · Add-ons · Upgrade / change

Payments
Bills · Pay now · Payment history

Support
Technical help · Live chat · My cases

Account
Profile · Settings · Documents · Offers

IMPACT & RESULTS

Measured across 90 days post-launch

The redesign launched across iOS, Android, and Web in Q4 2024. Results were tracked against the pre-launch baseline across usability, customer satisfaction, and operational KPIs.

METRIC	BEFORE	AFTER	CHANGE
First-attempt task success rate	38%	92%	+54pts
Average taps to complete top task	7.4 taps	2.8 taps	−62%
Drop-off on navigation flows	64%	31%	−52%
Support contacts (navigation)	310K/mo	183K/mo	−41%
App Store rating (combined)	2.6 / 5	4.5 / 5	+1.9pts
Post-task confidence (survey 1–5)	2.3 / 5	4.6 / 5	+2.3pts

REFLECTION

What I learned the hard way

This project taught me that navigation design is fundamentally a political act as much as a design act. Every team has a stake in where their feature lives in the hierarchy. The IA work was as much about facilitating stakeholder alignment as it was about user research.

01	Don't wait for perfect data before making structural decisions	Early stakeholder pressure pushed for designs before research was complete. I learned to share in-progress findings — not wait for a final report — to keep the process moving without sacrificing evidence-based decisions.
02	Test the navigation separately from the visual design	In early rounds, participants reacted to colour and style before navigating. Wireframe-only testing earlier would have separated navigation feedback from aesthetic feedback and given cleaner IA data.
03	Guided flows need opt-out, not just opt-in	The onboarding flow saw high skip rates among returning users who'd been added to the test cohort. Contextual triggers — not time-based ones — should determine who sees the guided experience.
04	A design system is only as good as its adoption process	Several engineering teams continued using legacy components post-launch despite the new system being ready. Adoption required dedicated onboarding sessions with each team — documentation alone was not enough.